

START HERE — NPSC CTSE 2026

You are sitting **10 papers across 19 days**, for **4 posts**, under **3 technical electives**.
This folder is everything you need. Read this page once, then work from the tracker.

Do this in the next 30 minutes

1. Read [01_MY_EXAM_SCHEDULE.md](#) — your exact dates, times, venues and mark scheme. Put all 7 exam dates in your phone calendar with alarms *today*.
2. Read [02_ROADMAP.md](#) — the 40-day plan and, more importantly, *why* it is shaped the way it is. Look hard at the overlap diagram.
3. Open [03_DAILY_TRACKER.md](#) and start Day 1. Today is Day 1.
4. Check your roll number against the General-paper venue table in the schedule file.

Then stop planning and start studying. The plan is done; you don't need to improve it.

What's in this folder

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prep/
├── 00_START_HERE.md           ← you are here
├── 01_MY_EXAM_SCHEDULE.md     ← dates, venues, marks, logistics checklist
├── 02_ROADMAP.md              ← 40-day plan, phase diagrams, daily rhythm, risks
├── 03_DAILY_TRACKER.md        ← tick-box plan for all 40 days
├──
├── Materials/
│   ├── _Shared/
│   │   ├── OFFICIAL_SYLLABUS.md ← ★ ground truth: official pattern + all 3 syllabi +
│   │   │   overlap map
│   │   ├── CORE_01 ... CORE_09 ← the shared technical core (pays into all 3 electives)
│   │   ├── General/             ← English + GK: playbook, essay bank, GK capsule
│   │   ├── ComputerScience_Degree/ ← compilers, algorithms, AI/ML, web/mobile + question
bank
│   ├── ComputerScience_Diploma/ ← MS Office, DOS, hardware + question bank
│   └── ComputerForensic/        ← forensic science, artifacts, cyber crime + question
bank
├── PYQ/                       ← past-year question papers, named + indexed
│   └── INDEX.md                ← start here for PYQs
├──
├── CTSE 2025 - Paper I - Questions and Answers.pdf ← ★ solved 2025 CS-Degree papers
├── CTSE 2025 - Paper II - Questions and Answers.pdf (you already had these – they
are gold)
├── CTSE 2025 - MCQ - Questions and Answers.pdf
├── CTSE 2025 - Concepts and Revision Notes.pdf
├──
└── _raw/                       ← downloaded source PDFs + scripts. Ignore unless
verifying.
```

The five things that actually decide your score

1. The MCQ is 200 marks — double any descriptive paper

Per elective: MCQ 200 · Paper-I 100 · Paper-II 100 · (General 100, shared). The MCQ is **40% of every elective** and it is the most learnable component. End every study day with MCQs. Most candidates get this backwards.

2. Negative marking makes guessing a maths problem

Each question is 2 marks; each wrong answer costs $1/3$ of $2 = 0.667$.

Situation	Expected value	Verdict
Blind guess, 4 options	$(0.25 \times 2) - (0.75 \times 0.667) = \mathbf{0.00}$	Pointless — pure coin-flip
1 option eliminated (3 left)	$(0.33 \times 2) - (0.67 \times 0.667) = \mathbf{+0.22}$	Guess
2 options eliminated (2 left)	$(0.50 \times 2) - (0.50 \times 0.667) = \mathbf{+0.67}$	Definitely guess

Rule: never guess blind, always guess once you can eliminate one option.

3. The descriptive papers give you choice — use it

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Section A: 10 questions offered → answer any 8 × 5 marks = 40
Section B: 5 questions offered → answer any 3 × 10 marks = 30
Section C: 4 questions offered → answer any 2 × 15 marks = 30
                                           Total = 100

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You can drop your two weakest topics in every section and still score full marks.

You need ~70% of the syllabus at real depth, not 100% at shallow depth. Choose depth.

4. 60% of your technical load is shared across all three electives

Digital logic · computer organisation · operating systems · UNIX · networks · DBMS · software engineering · data structures · C/C++ — these appear in *all three* of your electives. That's what `Materials/_Shared/CORE_*` is for. An hour there is an hour spent on three exams simultaneously. See the overlap table in `OFFICIAL_SYLLABUS.md` §5.

5. Your two real danger zones

Danger	Why	Where it's handled
Forensic science fundamentals — Locard's principle, chain of custody, crime scene procedure, Indian FSL structure	You're a software engineer. None of this is in your degree. And the Forensic exam is only 1 day after CS Degree ends, so it must be learned in early October, not at the end.	<code>Materials/ComputerForensic/FOR_01</code> , scheduled daily 1–9 Oct
MS Office & MS-DOS — Mail Merge, Excel referencing, Access queries, internal vs external DOS commands	A modern engineer genuinely may not know these, and the CS Diploma paper leans on them heavily. Easy marks that are easy to throw away.	<code>Materials/ComputerScience_Diploma/CSDip_02</code> , scheduled 26–28 Sep

Study method — the part most people skip

Retrieval beats re-reading, by a lot. Every session starts with 15 minutes of testing yourself on yesterday's material *with the notes closed*. It will feel uncomfortable and inefficient. It is neither. If you change one thing about how you study, change this.

Write by hand, timed. These are handwritten three-hour papers. Reading a model answer and producing one under time pressure are different skills, and only the second is examined. You need to know what a 5-mark answer *feels* like in length — roughly 5–6

solid points — before you're sitting in the hall.

Never skip a worked numerical. Scheduling Gantt charts, page-fault counting, subnetting, normalisation decompositions, K-maps, DP tables, entropy calculations — these are exactly what 10- and 15-mark answers are made of, and they cannot be bluffed.

Draw the diagrams. OSI stack, process state diagram, compiler phases, E-R diagrams, the forensic process model, crime-scene search patterns. Examiners reward them and they are fast marks.

Weekly self-check

Every Sunday, answer these honestly in the tracker:

- Did I hit my hours, or did I plan more than I did?
 - Which topic did I keep avoiding? (*That's the one to schedule first next week.*)
 - How many MCQs did I actually attempt?
 - Have I written an essay by hand this week?
 - Is the Forensic slot still being protected, or is CS Degree eating it?
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Before you go

- ⚠ **NPSC has already issued three corrigenda** to this advertisement (10, 15, 17 July 2026). Check npsc.nagaland.gov.in weekly for date changes, and download your admit card the moment it's released.
- The syllabus and pattern in `Materials/_Shared/OFFICIAL_SYLLABUS.md` are transcribed from the official NPSC PDFs (originals in `_raw/syllabus/`). If anything anywhere else in this folder contradicts that file, **the official file wins**.

You have 40 days and a clear plan. Go and do Day 1.